

Strings in Python

part three

8. Split and join

Join a list of strings into a string

Join a list of strings into a list. Here white-space is used for joining the words.

```
1 my_lst = ["Hello", "World", "!"]  
2 print(" ".join(my_lst))
```

Hello World !

But you can also use another string for joining

```
1 my_lst = ["Hello", "World", "!"]  
2 print("-".join(my_lst))
```

Hello-World-!

Note that it needs to be a list of *strings* that you are joining. Otherwise, you will get a `TypeError`.

Join with an empty string

You can, of course, also use an empty string for joining the list of strings.

```
1 alphabet_lst = list("abcdefghijklm")
2 print(alphabet_lst)
3 alphabet_lst[3] = "9"
4 print(alphabet_lst)
5
6 # Joining with the empty string
7 alphabet_str = "".join(alphabet_lst)
8 print(alphabet_str)
```

```
['a', 'b', 'c', 'd', 'e', 'f', 'g', 'h', 'i', 'j', 'k', 'l', 'm']
['a', 'b', 'c', '9', 'e', 'f', 'g', 'h', 'i', 'j', 'k', 'l', 'm']
abc9efghijklm
```

The split() method

`split()` could be thought of as some kind of opposite to `join()`, which instead splits a string into a list.

```
1 my_str = "It 's a nice day"  
2 my_str.split(" ")
```

`["It's", 'a', 'nice', 'day']`

Any string can be used for splitting

```
1 slash_str = "1//2//3//4//5 "  
2 slash_str.split("//")
```

`['1', '2', '3', '4', '5']`